

DevOps 30-Day Interview Prep

DAY 1 - Linux Production Revision Notes

1. Server Basics

whoami -> Current logged in user
hostname -> Server name
uptime -> Server running time + load average

Interview Focus:
Always understand which machine and user you are debugging.

2. Process Management

Commands:

ps aux
ps aux | grep nginx
top
htop

PID:
Every running program gets a unique Process ID.

Example:
nginx process -> PID -> troubleshoot/kill

3. Linux Services (systemd)

systemctl status nginx
systemctl start nginx
systemctl stop nginx
systemctl restart nginx

systemd manages services.
Services create processes.

4. Ports & Networking

sudo ss -tulpn

Checks:

- Which port is listening
- Which process owns the port

Example:
Port 80 -> nginx
Port 3000 -> NodeJS

5. Kill Signals

kill -15 PID

Graceful shutdown.
Use first in production.

kill -9 PID

Force kill.
Use only as last option.

Production Incident: 502 Bad Gateway

Architecture:

```
ALB
|
Nginx
|
NodeJS :3000
```

Debug Order:

1. systemctl status nginx
2. sudo ss -tulpn
3. curl localhost:3000
4. journalctl -u nginx
5. Restart only after root cause found

Production Incident: CPU 99%

Debug Order:

1. uptime
Check server load

2. top / htop
Find high CPU process

3. ps aux | grep process
Investigate PID

4. ss -tulpn
Check traffic

5. journalctl / logs
Find root cause

Day 1 Score

Score: 7/10

Strong:

- systemctl
- PID
- Process basics
- Debug mindset

Improve:

- ss command
- logs
- exact troubleshooting order

Before Day 2 Revision

Practice:

systemctl status nginx

ps aux | grep nginx

sudo ss -tulpn

journalctl -u nginx

top

Remember:
Think like production engineer, not student.